closely, you can see that I've actually caught the ball. I caught it and chucked it away. That constitutes control in my book. You can even tell that I've caught it by the look on my face. I'm looking over at the Aussie dressing room, wanting to send them the message, 'That's you gone, done and dusted.' From my point of view, I caught the ball … I caught it 100 per cent.

But of course I should not have thrown it away so quickly. And in throwing it away, I dropped it.

I was shocked when the umpires ruled Waugh 'not out'. Seriously shocked. I remember Hansie coming over to me and asking, 'Hersch, did you catch the ball, or what's the story?' I think I was in more shock than anybody else. I remember looking up at the replay on the big screen and seeing that I'd caught the ball, but then had spilt it in my haste to get rid of it.

So, to be on the safe side, I told Hansie, 'No, I dropped it.' It was a major game and there would've been huge drama if I had claimed the catch. It looked like I'd dropped it, but I knew I had had that ball under control. Looking back now, obviously I should have held it for another second before throwing it in the air. Steve Waugh would've walked back to the dressing room, having scored 56 instead of going on to play one of his best one-day innings, scoring 120 not out. At that stage, it was only his second ton (in 266 ODIs).

Then, of course, there's the myth of what Steve Waugh said to me afterwards. Some people claim that he'd said, 'You have just dropped the World Cup,' but, like I've said many times since, I never ever heard him say those words on the field. Perhaps he said it later, at a press conference, but I never heard him say it on the field.

Anyway, Waugh's century helped Australia chase down our total of 271, and they won by five wickets with a couple of balls to spare. And that, of course, meant we had to face them again in the semis. Had we beaten them in the Super Six game, we would have knocked them out of the tournament and we would've had an easier semi. We could have carried that momentum into the final. But, ja, we had to face the Australians again in the semis.

In the semi-final we had to chase a reasonably easy target of 213. Allan and Polly's bowling had been great – Polly took five wickets and Allan four. Gary and I opened our innings, and we were going great guns. Both of us really got hold of Damien Fleming.